

tered design process. The Empathise mode is the work you do to understand people, within the context of your design challenge. It's your effort to understand the way they do things and why, their physical and emotional needs, how they think about world, and what is meaningful to them.

Why?

As design thinkers, you'll be solving problems that are not your own – they are those of a group of people; in order to design for them, you must gain empathy for who they are and what is important to them. Empathising gives you a better set of eyes to gain insights that would have filtered out without you even realising it. Good designs are built solely based on the user groups' beliefs, values and needs that can be found out by empathising with them.

How?

You can empathise with your users simply by observing things like disconnect between what the user says and does; by engaging the user in conversation with questions to gain deeper meaning; by watching how they interact with an object while performing a task; and by listening to what's going on inside their mind by asking them to be vocal about it.

2. DEFINE A FOCUSED PROBLEM STATEMENT

Framing the right problem is the only way to create the right solution.

What?

The Define mode of the design process is all about bringing clarity and focus to the design space. This stage is about making sense of the widespread information that you've gathered through empathy. It's also about defining the challenge that you're undertaking based on your understanding of the user and the context of the problem. The goal should be building a point-of-view (POV) and making sense of insights by synthesising information to discover patterns and connections.

Why?

By describing a narrow problem solving POV, you'll yield both, greater quantity and higher quality of solutions while generating ideas, even though it might seem counter-intuitive. The Define Mode is an endeavor to shape scattered findings into powerful insights to build better designs.

How?

Consider what stood out to you when talking and observing people. What patterns emerge when you look at the set? If you noticed something interesting, ask yourself (and your team) why that might be. Work to express INSIGHTS you developed through the synthesis of information you've gathered through empathy and research work. Then articulate a point-of-view by combining these three elements – user, need and insight – as an actionable problem statement that will drive the rest of your design work.

3. IDEATE AS A TEAM

It's not about coming up with the 'right' idea; it's about generating the broadest range of possibilities.

What?

Ideate is that mode of the design process in which you concentrate on idea generation. Ideation provides both, the fuel and also the

unconscious mind, and rational thoughts with imagination. For example, in a brainstorm you leverage the synergy of the group to reach new ideas by building on others' ideas. There are other ideation techniques such as body-storming, mind-mapping and sketching. But one theme throughout all of them is deferring judgment – that is, separating the generation of ideas from the evaluation of ideas.

4. PROTOTYPE A TANGIBLE MODEL

Build to think and test to learn.

What?

The Prototype mode is the iterative generation of artifacts intended to answer questions that get you closer to your final solution. In the early stages, you should create low-resolution prototypes that are quick and cheap to make (think minutes and cents), but can elicit useful feedback from users and colleagues. In later stages, both, your prototype and

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source material for building prototypes and getting innovative solutions into the hands of your users.

Why?

You ideate in order to transition from identifying problems to creating solutions for your users. Ideation is your chance to combine the understanding you have of the problem area and people you're designing for with your imagination to generate solution concepts. Particularly early in a design project, ideation is about pushing for the widest possible range of ideas from which you can select, not simply finding a single best solution. The determination of the best solution will be discovered later, through user testing and feedback.

How?

You ideate by combining your conscious and

question may get a bit more refined. A prototype can be anything that a user can interact with – be it a wall of post-it notes, a gadget you put together, a role-playing activity or even a storyboard.

Why?

Prototyping is necessary to ideate and problem solve, to communicate, to fail quickly and cheaply (and thus test more possibilities), and to manage the solution building process.

How?

To start prototyping, keep the idea in mind and begin building but don't spend too much time on one prototype. You must take note of the key variable addressed by each prototype to be able to finally build with the user in mind and get meaningful feedback in the testing phase.